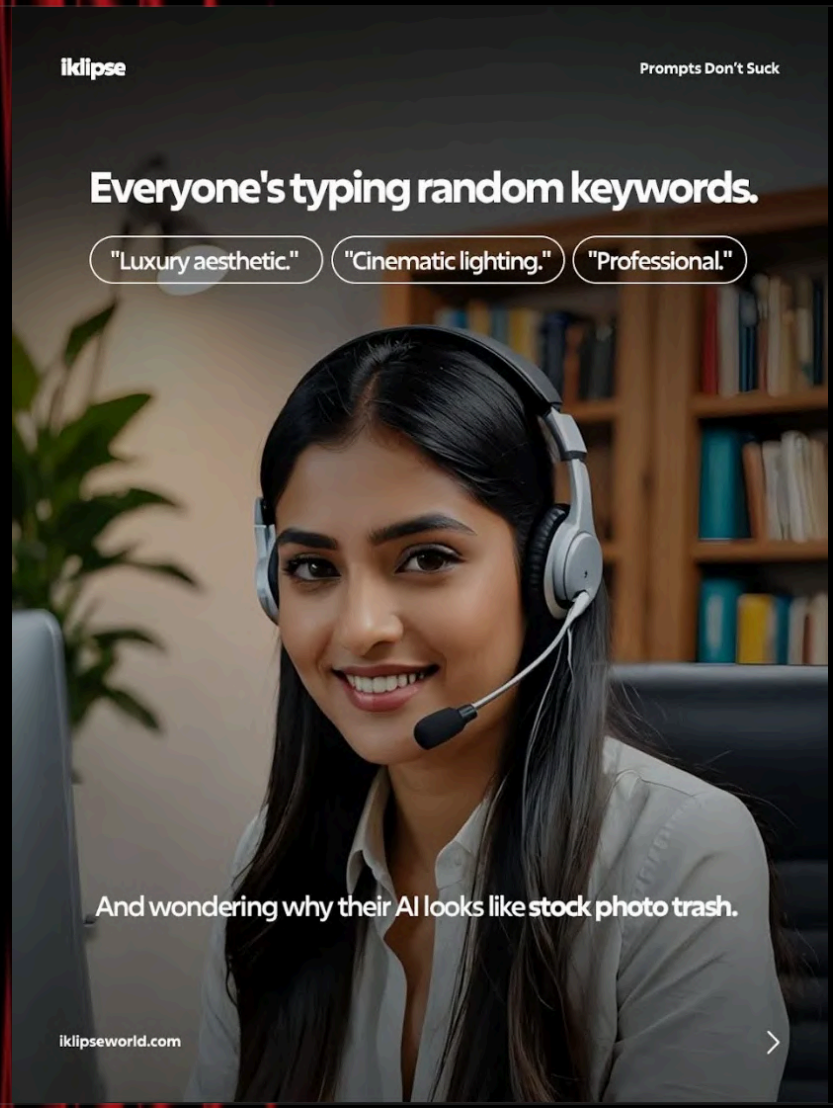
IMAGE REFERENCE FRAMEWORK

Why Your References Matter More Than Your Prompts

The Problem

GOOD PROMPTS AREN'T ENOUGH

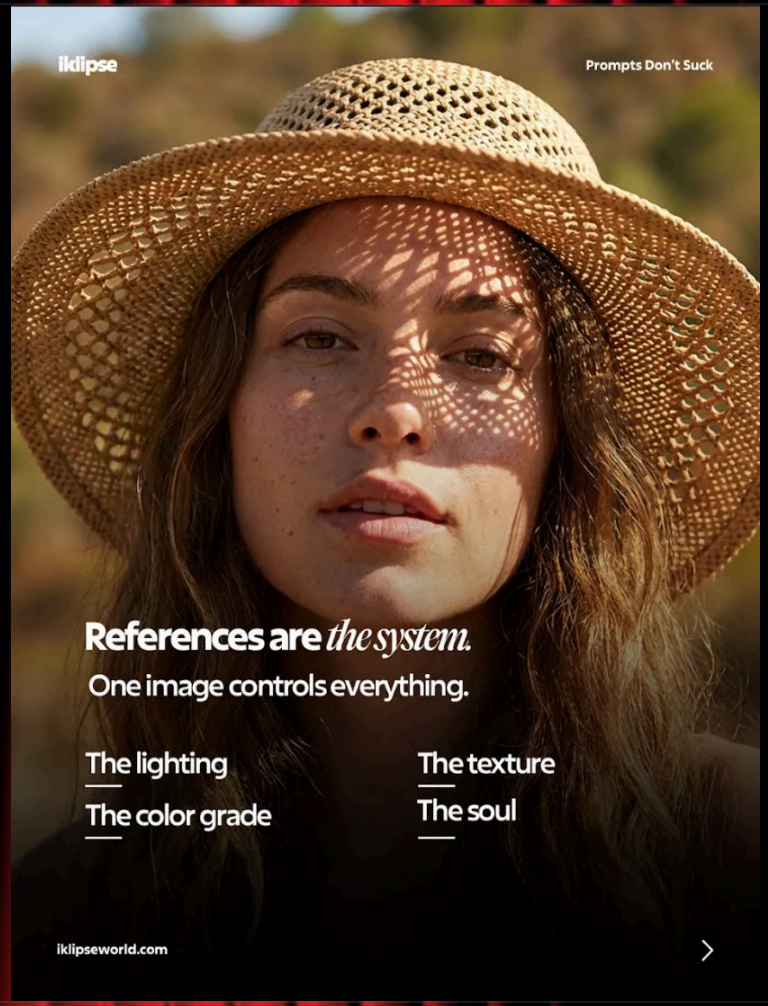
- You've written the perfect prompt.
- You've tweaked every single word.
- But your AI output still looks generic.
- **Why?** Your references are weak.



WHAT REFERENCES ACTUALLY CONTROL

Style & Aesthetic	**Camera Angle**	**Lighting**
Texture & Material	**Color Grade**	**Mood & Emotion**

"References are the visual DNA. Prompts are just instructions."



PINTEREST GEMS

Part 1: Angles & Composition



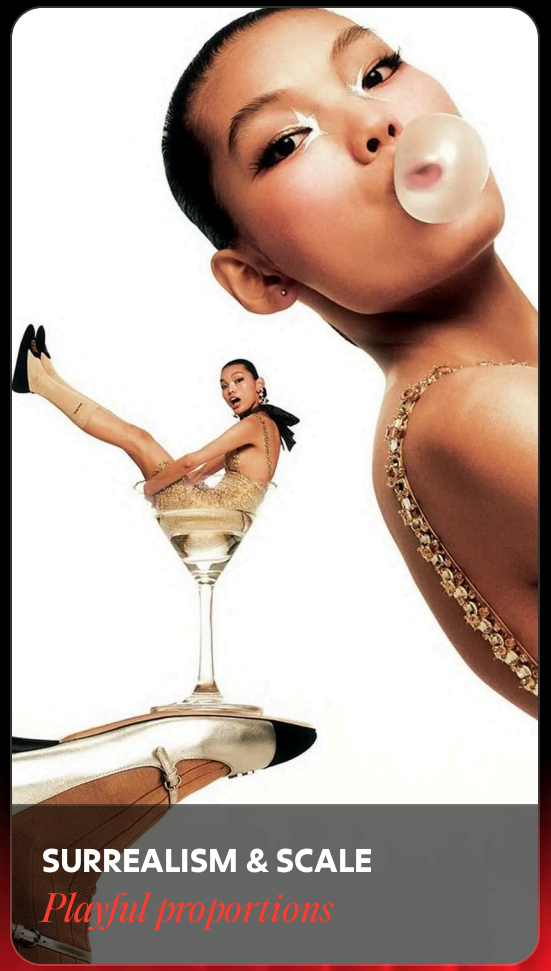
UNIQUE LOW ANGLE

Framing from below



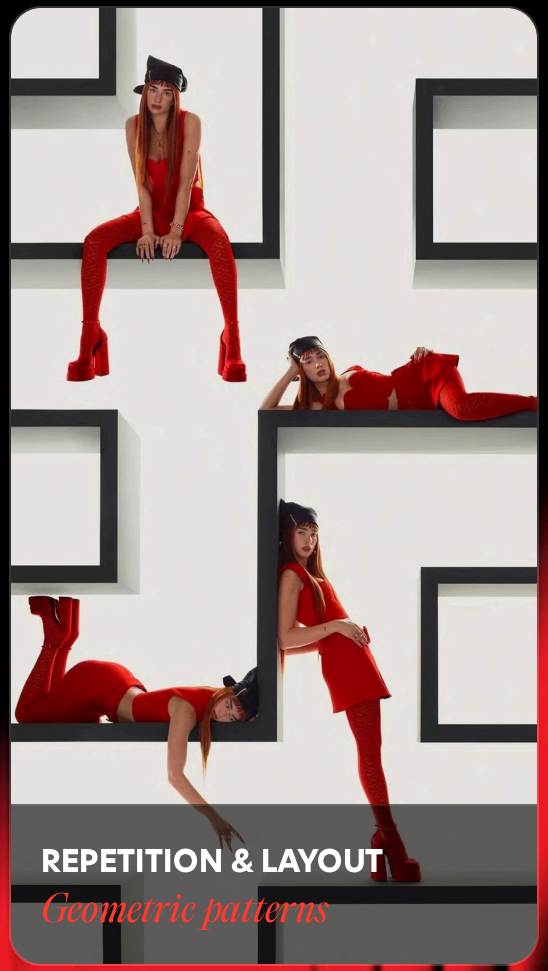
POV & LIFESTYLE

Immersive perspective



SURREALISM & SCALE

Playful proportions



REPETITION & LAYOUT

Geometric patterns

PINTERREST GEMS

Part 2: Style & Texture



WIDE ANGLE & PALETTE

Distorted perspective



TEXTURE & PATTERN

Organic repetition



EDITORIAL POSE

Unconventional framing



COLOR BLOCKING

Hard flash aesthetic



LIGHTING & SHADOWS

Creative obscuration

STYLE TRANSFER IN ACTION

ORIGIN

Tupac Portrait

REFERENCE

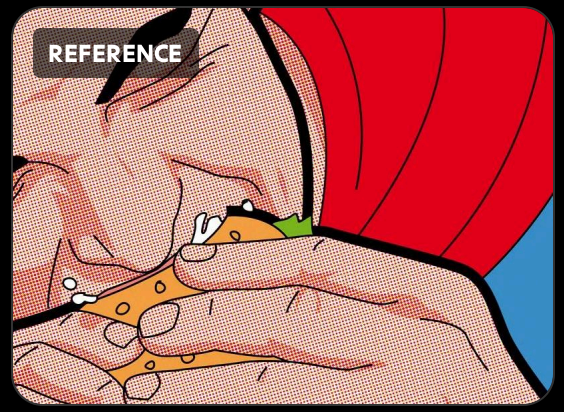
Pop Art Style

THE PROMPT

> *"Create me a photo of tupac (refer to the second image) smiling with a thumbs up in the same textural and artistic style of the reference image"*

"Subject Identity + Reference Style = Perfect Hybrid"





RESULT



Real Example #2

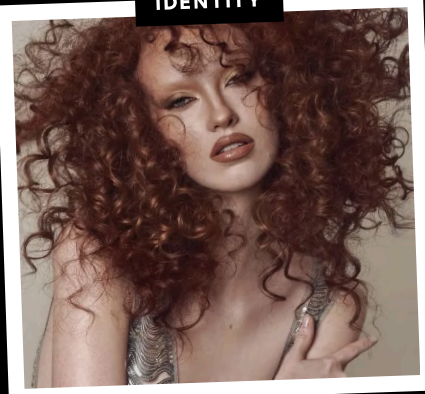
ADVANCED STACKING

IDENTITY	Curly Hair Ref
OUTFIT	Red Dress Ref
POSE	Squatting Ref

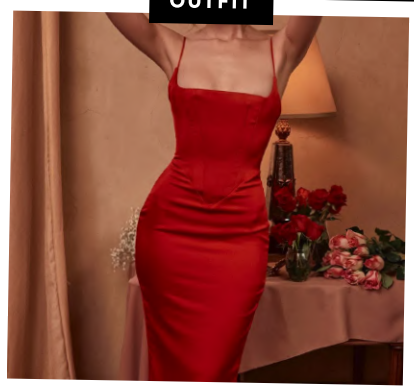
"Using the face of the curly-haired woman from image two as a strict identity reference, place her in the red dress outfit from image one while strictly matching the pose..."

"Precise control over every element."

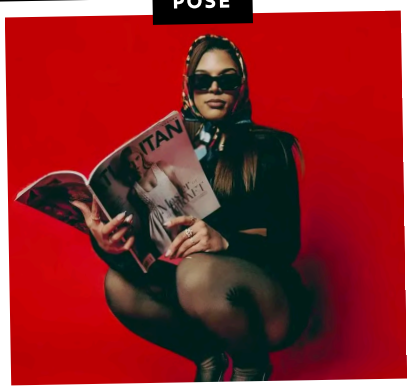
IDENTITY



OUTFIT



POSE



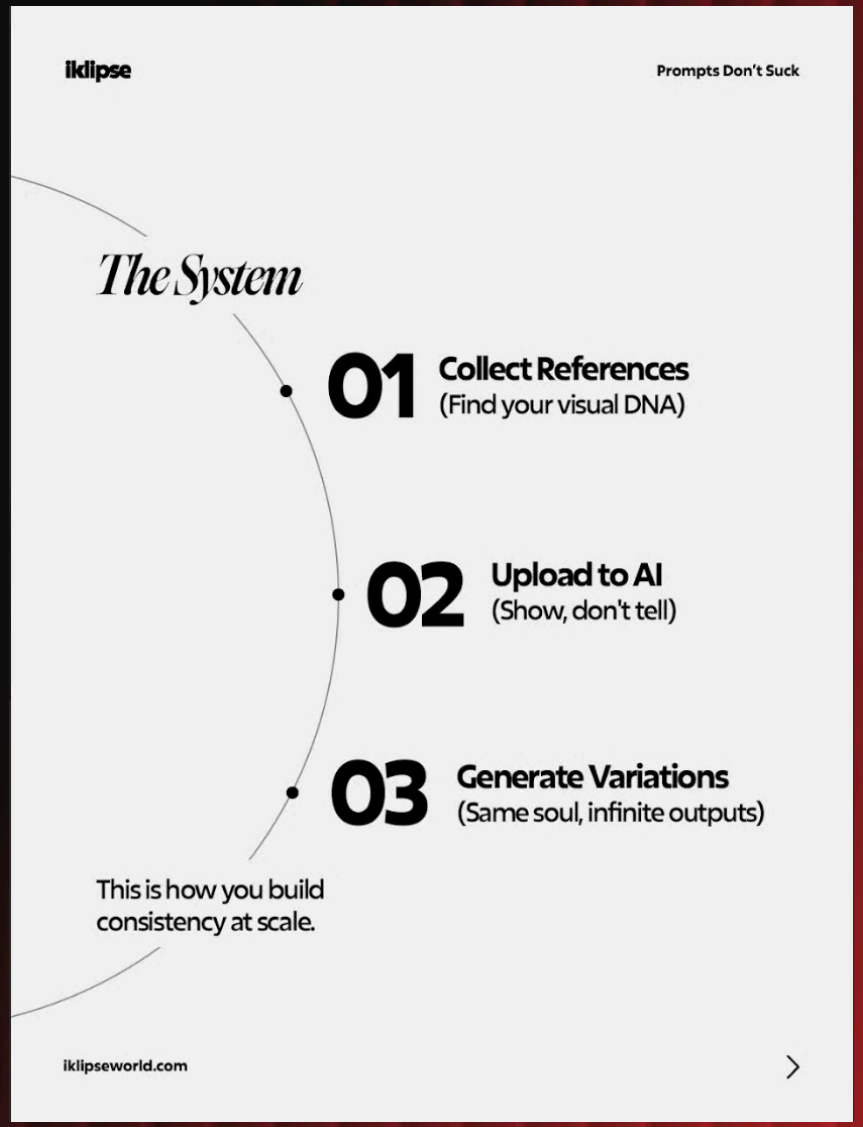
THE RESULT



THE 3-STEP SYSTEM

This is how you build consistency at scale.

1. Find your visual DNA
2. Upload to AI
3. Write reference-based prompts



STEP 1: FINDING REFERENCES

Pinterest is your visual search engine.

SEARCH STRATEGY

01 Don't search for "cool image." Search for specific **attributes**.

02 Use technical keywords: "Editorial," "Cinematic," "Studio Lighting."

03 Look for the "Visual Hook"—one element that stands out.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

- ✓ **Lighting:** Clear shadows and highlights.
- ✓ **Texture:** Visible skin, fabric, or material details.
- ✓ **Composition:** Clean background or distinct subject.

"If the reference is blurry, your result will be blurry."

KEYWORD COMBINATIONS TO TRY

Editorial Photography

"editorial photography"
"magazine aesthetic"
"high fashion editorial"
"luxury editorial"

Cinematic Style

"cinematic lighting"
"film photography"
"moody cinematic"
"warm cinematic"

Product Photography

"luxury product photography"
"minimalist product"
"studio lighting product"

Portrait Style

"beauty portrait lighting"
"professional headshot"
"natural light portrait"
"studio portrait"

Lifestyle

"lifestyle photography aesthetic"
"aspirational lifestyle"
"luxury lifestyle"

Specific Moods

"golden hour photography"
"moody dark aesthetic"
"bright and airy"

Pro Tip: Combine 2-3 keywords for more specific results

TWO TYPES OF REFERENCES

Origin Image

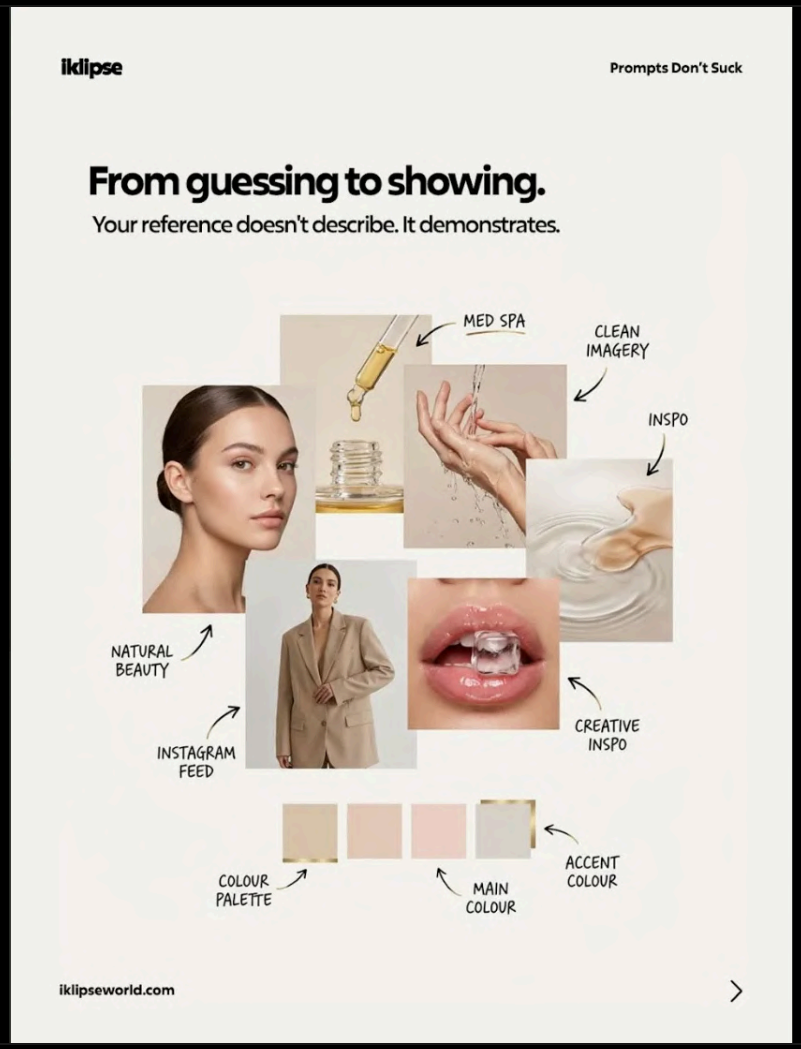
The subject you want to recreate. This is the "what" — a person, product, or specific scene you'll ask AI to transform.

Attribute References

The style you want to apply. These control the "how".

Lighting | Camera Angle | Texture | Color Grade | Mood

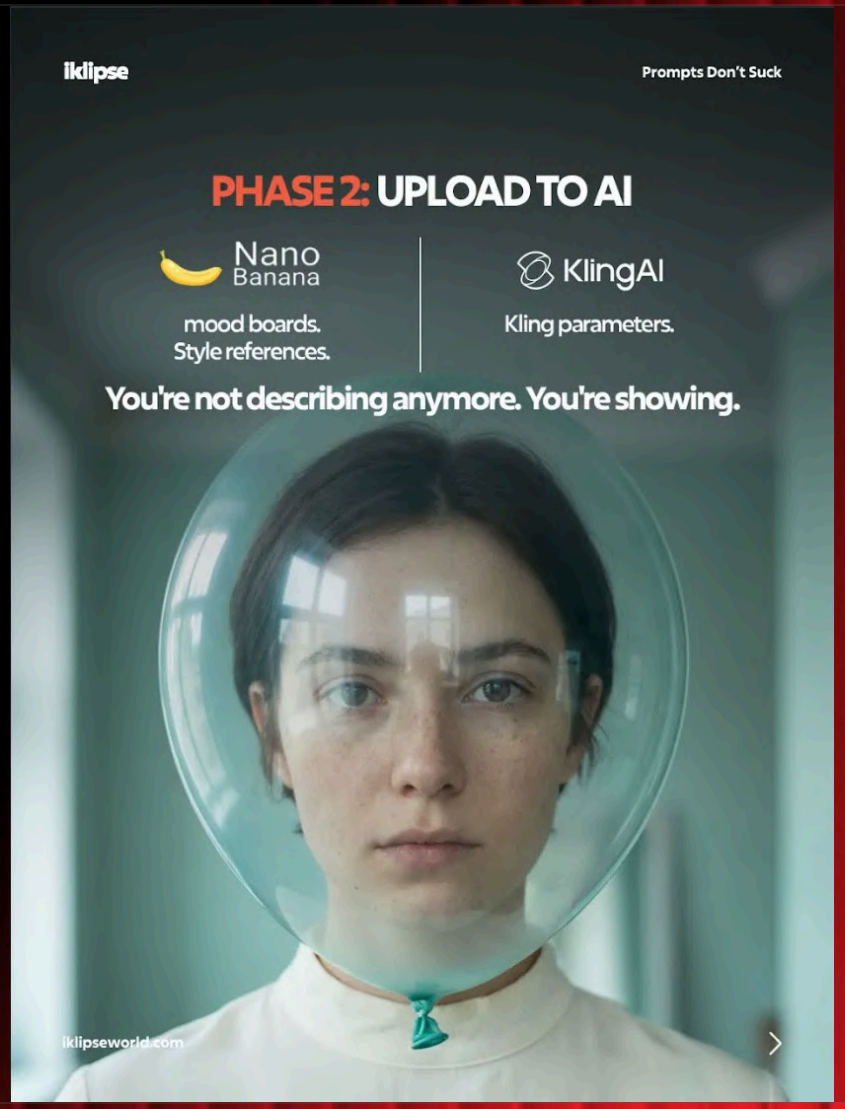
"You can mix and match attributes from different images."



STEP 2: UPLOADING TO NANO BANANA

1. Go to Nano Banana (nanobanana.com)
2. Create a new project
3. Upload your reference images
4. Organize by type (Origin vs. Attributes)
5. Label each reference clearly

"Keep your reference board organized. You'll use it repeatedly."



Step 3: The Prompt

THE BASIC FORMULA

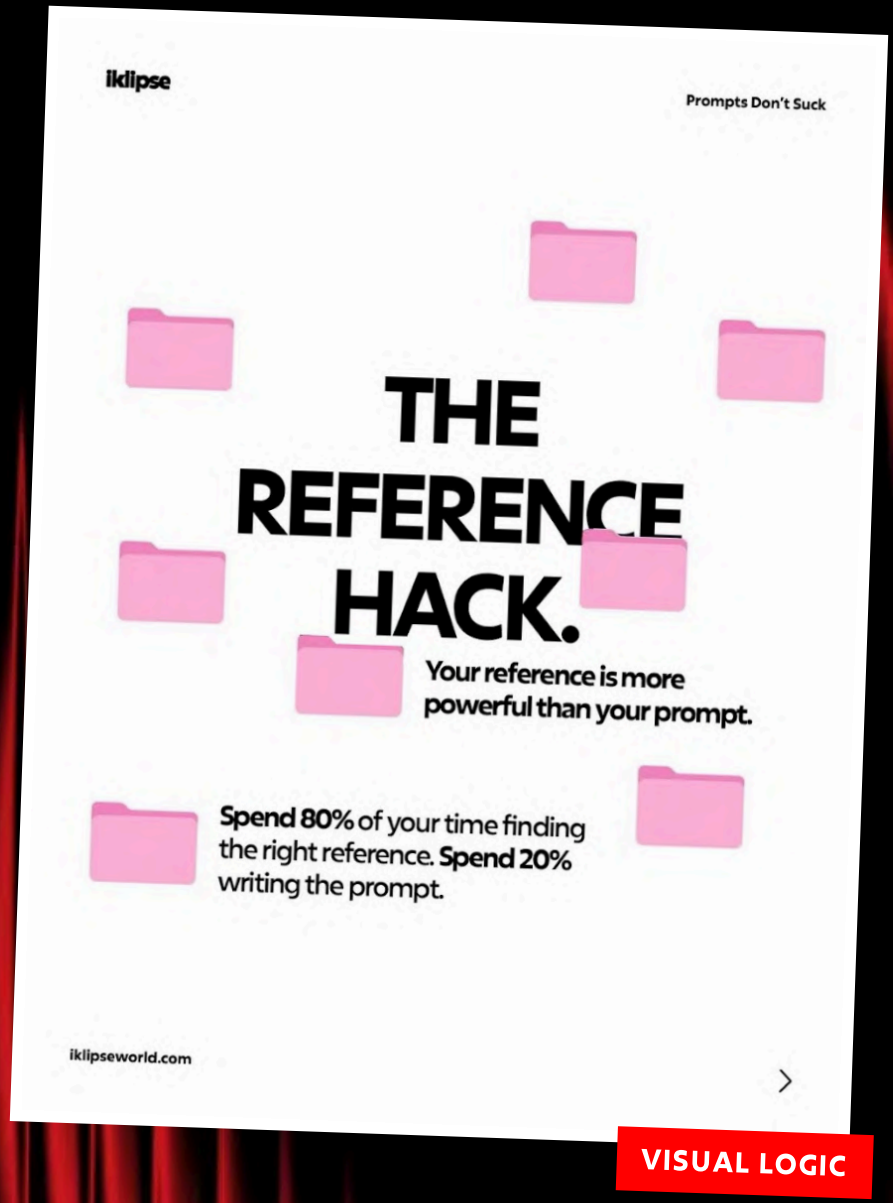
Stop describing the lighting. Stop describing the camera angle. **Just point to the reference.**

1. **Take [Subject] from** ORIGIN IMAGE

   \+ **Apply [Style] from** REFERENCE IMAGE

WHY THIS WORKS

Nano Banana doesn't need a paragraph of text. It needs **coordinates**. Your Origin Image provides the "What", and your Reference Image provides the "How".



ADVANCED: STACK MULTIPLE REFERENCES

"Take **[SUBJECT]** from **[ORIGIN IMAGE]** and apply:

- The **[ATTRIBUTE 1]** from **[REF IMAGE 1]**
- The **[ATTRIBUTE 2]** from **[REF IMAGE 2]**
- The **[ATTRIBUTE 3]** from **[REF IMAGE 3]**"

EXAMPLE

"Take the model from Image 1 and apply the overhead camera angle from Image 2, the studio lighting from Image 3, and the luxury aesthetic from Image 4."

"Each reference controls one specific element."



MULTIPLE ORIGIN IMAGES

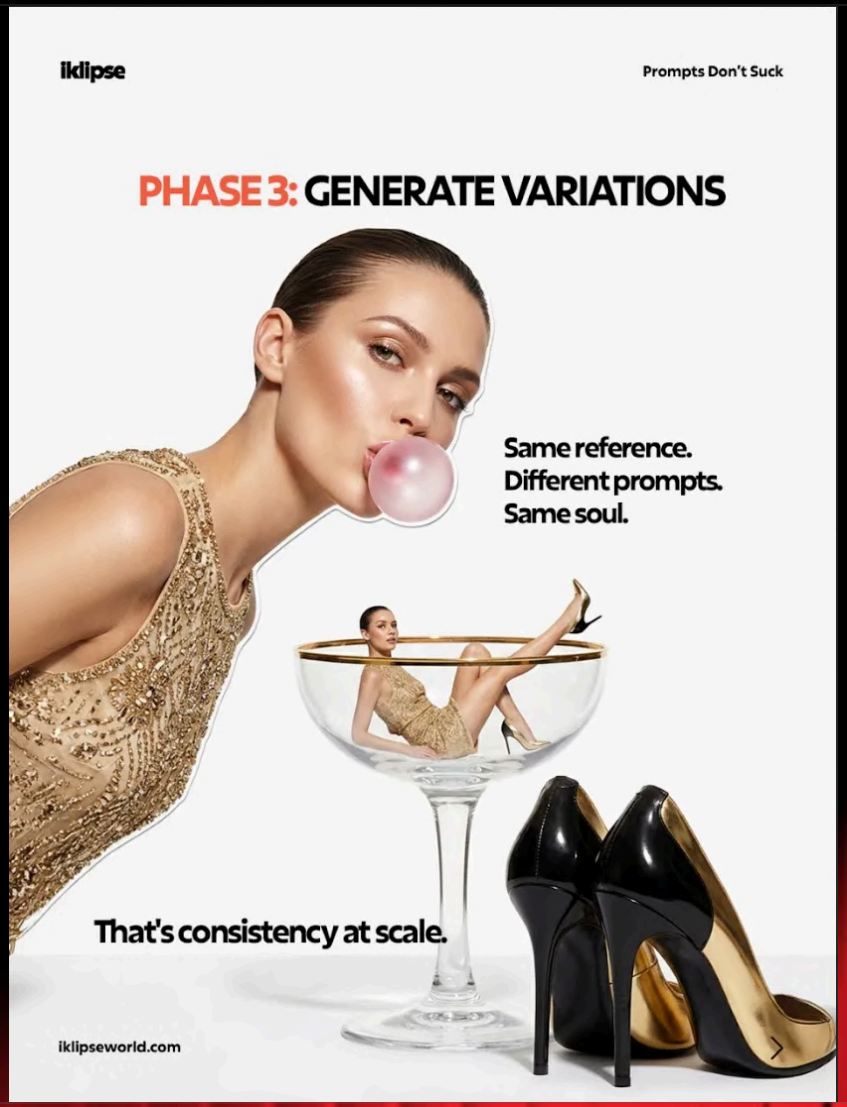
When You Have Multiple Subject Options

THE FORMULA

"Combine [SUBJECT 1] from [IMAGE 1]
with [SUBJECT 2] from [IMAGE 2],
using the [ATTRIBUTE] from [REFERENCE IMAGE]"

Example:
"Combine the styling from Image 1 with the pose from Image 2, using the moody lighting from Image 3"

> **Best for testing different variations while keeping the style consistent.**



WHAT NOT TO DO

Using Low-Quality References

Problem: Blurry, poorly lit, or generic images confuse the AI.

→ **Solution: Choose sharp, well-composed references.**

Being Vague About Attributes

Problem: "Make it look better" doesn't give specific direction.

→ **Solution: "Apply the warm golden hour lighting from Image 2."**

Too Many References

Problem: Overloading the prompt with 10+ images creates chaos.

→ **Solution: Stick to 3-5 key references per prompt.**

Not Labeling References

Problem: Forgetting which image controls which attribute.

→ **Solution: Label clearly (Lighting, Angle, Mood) in Nano Banana.**

YOUR REFERENCE CHECKLIST

Don't hit generate until you've checked these boxes.

01. THE REFERENCE AUDIT

- [ ] **Is the lighting distinct?**
  Does it have clear shadows and highlights, or is it flat?
- [ ] **Is the texture visible?**
  Can you see skin pores, fabric weave, or material grain?
- [ ] **Is the composition clear?**
  Is the subject placement obvious enough for the AI to mimic?

02. THE PROMPT LOGIC

- [ ] **Is the Subject defined?**
  Did you clearly state WHAT the main subject is?
- [ ] **Is the Role assigned?**
  Did you tell the AI to use the reference for "Style" or "Structure"?
- [ ] **Is it simple?**
  Did you remove unnecessary adjectives that fight the reference?

NEXT STEPS

Your roadmap to visual consistency.

01 AUDIT YOUR FEED

Don't just scroll. Save 5 images that stop you in your tracks. Look for the "visual hook."

02 DEFINE YOUR DNA

Identify the common thread. Is it the lighting? The texture? The mood? Name it.

03 EXECUTE

Upload your best reference to Nano Banana. Use the formula: "Subject + Reference Style + Context"

STOP GUESSING.

Start Referencing.

Cast your shadow

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